

65 First times

When you talk about the first time something happened, such as visiting a new place, you often use “never” or “ever” with the past perfect or present perfect.

⚙️ **New language** “Never” / “ever” with past tenses

Aa **Vocabulary** Travel adjectives

🧩 **New skill** Describing new experiences

65.1 KEY LANGUAGE PAST PERFECT WITH “NEVER” / “EVER”

Use the past perfect with “never” or “ever” to talk about events in the past that happened for the first time.



PAST SIMPLE

PAST PERFECT WITH “NEVER”

Leo was very excited. He **had never visited** Rome before.

“Never” means this had not happened before. It sits between “had” and the past participle.

PAST SIMPLE

PAST PERFECT WITH “EVER”

Leo was very excited. It was the first time he **had ever visited** Rome.

“Ever” emphasizes that this is the first time it had happened.



65.2 CROSS OUT THE INCORRECT WORD IN EACH SENTENCE

Tom had **never** / ~~ever~~ been on a plane before his trip to Madagascar.

- 1 Last summer was the first time we had **never** / **ever** gone camping. It rained every day!
- 2 I had **never** / **ever** eaten risotto until I went to Milan. Now I cook it for myself at home.
- 3 They had **never** / **ever** been overseas before they went to Paris. They thought the flight was exciting!
- 4 We traveled overnight from Bangkok. It was the first time I had **never** / **ever** slept on a train.
- 5 I heard you went to Madrid last month. Was that the first time you had **never** / **ever** been there?
- 6 James had **never** / **ever** been bungee jumping until he tried it in New Zealand last year.

